

Structuring frameworks to guide observation

- Three easy-to-remember parts:
 - The person: Who is using this technology at a particular time?
 - The place: Where are they using it?
 - The thing: What are they doing with it?
- A more detailed framework (Robson, 2014):
 - Space: What is the physical space like and how is it laid out?
 - Actors: What are the names and relevant details of the people involved?
 - Activities: What are the actors doing and why?
 - Objects: What physical objects are present, such as furniture
 - Acts: What are specific individual actions?
 - Events: Is what you observe part of a special event?
 - Time: What is the sequence of events?
 - Goals: What are the actors trying to accomplish?
 - Feelings: What is the mood of the group and of individuals?

Planning and conducting observation in the field

- Decide on how involved you will be: passive observer to active participant
- How to gain acceptance
- How to handle sensitive topics, eg. culture, private spaces, etc.
- How to collect the data:
 - What data to collect
 - What equipment to use
 - When to stop observing